# Validation Criteria Standard

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**Subcategory:** Validation Governance
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**Governed Space:** Validation Criteria
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**Canonical Language:** English (UCL™)

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## Canonical Definition

**Validation Criteria Standard (VCRS)** defines the governance conditions under which the criteria, requirements, thresholds, acceptance conditions, rejection conditions, evaluation references, and decision boundaries used to determine validity are formally established, justified, structured, maintained, and controlled before validation methodology and execution are applied.

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## Canonical Definition Extension

A Validation Object may be precisely established.

Its Validation Purpose and Scope may be clearly defined.

Neither determines what conditions the object must satisfy in order to support a validation determination.

Validation requires explicit criteria.

Without governed criteria, validation risks becoming dependent upon implicit expectations, changing thresholds, subjective interpretation, post-hoc reasoning, or standards selected after results are already known.

Validation Criteria Standard therefore governs the transformation of an approved Validation Mandate into a formally defined **Validation Criteria Framework.**

The standard establishes the governance conditions necessary to determine:

- what properties or conditions must be evaluated,
- which requirements are relevant to the Validation Purpose,
- which criteria are mandatory or conditional,
- which thresholds distinguish acceptable from unacceptable conditions,
- what constitutes satisfaction or non-satisfaction,
- how criteria relate to different parts of Validation Scope,
- which external references may legitimately inform criteria,
- how conflicts between criteria are governed,
- and when criteria must be changed or reassessed.

VCRS does not determine which technical procedure should be used to evaluate a criterion.

It does not determine whether available evidence is sufficient.

It does not execute validation.

It does not issue the final Validation Determination.

**VCRS establishes the governed conditions against which validity can later be meaningfully evaluated.**

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## Core Question

**Against which explicit, justified, and governable conditions should the Validation Object be evaluated in order to determine whether the Validation Purpose has been satisfied?**

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## Purpose

The purpose of Validation Criteria Standard is to ensure that validation judgments are based upon criteria established before conclusions are reached.

The standard prevents validity from being determined through:

- undefined expectations,
- implicit requirements,
- arbitrary thresholds,
- moving evaluation targets,
- selective criteria,
- post-hoc criteria creation,
- incompatible criteria,
- or criteria unrelated to the approved Validation Purpose and Scope.

VCRS creates the evaluation foundation upon which subsequent validation methodology, evidence, execution, and determination depend.

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## Governance Objective

VCRS establishes a governed Validation Criteria Framework capable of supporting consistent, explainable, traceable, and reproducible validation determinations.

The standard seeks to ensure that:

- validation criteria are explicit,
- criteria are relevant to the Validation Purpose,
- criteria correspond to the approved Validation Scope,
- criteria sources are identifiable,
- criteria are sufficiently precise for evaluation,
- thresholds are justified,
- acceptance and rejection conditions are distinguishable,
- mandatory and conditional criteria remain distinguishable,
- criteria conflicts are governed,
- criteria changes remain traceable,
- and subsequent validation activity can be evaluated against a stable reference.

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## Operational Role

Validation Criteria Standard serves as the **evaluation-reference stage of the VALIDOS® validation governance lifecycle.**

It receives:

### Validation Object + Validation Mandate

and establishes:

### Validation Criteria Framework

capable of guiding subsequent validation methodology and execution.

Its architectural role is to answer the question that follows Validation Purpose & Scope:

### Now that we know what is being validated and why, against what conditions should validity be judged?

The Validation Criteria Framework becomes the governed reference against which later evidence and validation results can be interpreted.

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## Governance Scope

Validation Criteria Standard governs:

- validation criteria,
- validation requirements,
- criterion relevance,

- criterion applicability,
- criterion structure,
- criterion hierarchy,
- mandatory criteria,
- conditional criteria,
- acceptance conditions,
- rejection conditions,
- validation thresholds,
- threshold justification,
- evaluation references,
- criterion dependencies,
- criterion conflicts,
- criterion stability,
- criterion change,
- criterion traceability,
- and Validation Criteria Framework integrity.

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## Validation Criteria Governance Model

VCRS establishes the following progression: **Validation Mandate → Requirement Identification → Criterion Definition → Threshold Establishment → Acceptance & Rejection Conditions → Criteria Alignment → Criteria Integrity → Validation Criteria Framework**

This progression converts the purpose and scope of validation into explicit conditions against which the Validation Object can subsequently be evaluated.

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## Validation Requirement Identification

Criteria must originate from identifiable validation requirements.

Relevant requirements may arise from:

- the approved Validation Purpose,
- intended use,
- Validation Scope,
- operational requirements,
- safety requirements,
- performance requirements,
- integrity requirements,
- governance requirements,
- contractual requirements,
- regulatory requirements,
- legal requirements,
- domain standards,
- scientific knowledge,
- technical specifications,
- risk conditions,
- or other legitimate validation references.

The existence of a requirement does not automatically make it an appropriate validation criterion.

VCRS requires its relevance to the Validation Purpose and Scope to be established.

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## Criterion Definition

Each material validation criterion should be sufficiently precise to allow subsequent validation activity to determine whether the relevant condition has been satisfied.

Where appropriate, a criterion should identify:

- the characteristic being evaluated,
- the requirement being tested,
- the relevant Validation Scope element,
- the applicable condition,
- the expected state,
- the evaluation boundary,
- and the basis upon which satisfaction can later be determined.

Criteria should not depend upon undefined concepts where those concepts materially affect the validation determination.

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## Criteria Classification

Validation criteria may require different governance treatment.

VCRS may distinguish, where applicable:

### Mandatory Criteria

Conditions that must be satisfied for a defined validation outcome to be possible.

### Conditional Criteria

Conditions that apply only when specified circumstances, uses, environments, configurations, populations, or dependencies exist.

### Supporting Criteria

Criteria providing additional validation information without independently determining the primary validation outcome.

### Exclusionary Criteria

Conditions whose occurrence may prevent a specified validation outcome regardless of performance against other criteria.

### Composite Criteria

Criteria whose determination depends upon multiple subordinate conditions or measurements.

Classification prevents materially different criteria from being treated as equivalent.

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## Validation Thresholds

Where a criterion requires a measurable or classifiable boundary, VCRS governs the establishment of an appropriate validation threshold.

Thresholds may represent:

- minimum acceptable values,
- maximum permitted values,
- ranges,
- tolerances,
- confidence levels,
- error boundaries,
- performance levels,
- evidence thresholds,
- categorical conditions,
- binary conditions,
- or other governable decision boundaries.

A threshold should have an identifiable methodological basis.

Thresholds should not be modified after results are known merely to produce a preferred validation outcome.

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## Acceptance Conditions

Acceptance conditions establish what must be demonstrated for a criterion to be treated as sufficiently satisfied.

Acceptance may be:

- complete,
- conditional,
- threshold-based,
- multi-factor,
- evidence-dependent,
- context-dependent,
- or otherwise governed according to the nature of the criterion.

Acceptance of one criterion does not automatically establish validity of the complete Validation Object.

The relationship between individual criterion results and the final Validation Determination belongs to later VALIDOS® governance.

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## Rejection Conditions

Rejection conditions establish circumstances under which a criterion cannot be considered satisfied.

These may include:

- threshold failure,
- prohibited conditions,
- insufficient required performance,
- incompatible states,
- unacceptable uncertainty,
- missing mandatory requirements,
- or other predefined failure conditions.

VCRS requires rejection conditions to remain distinguishable from:

- missing evidence,
- incomplete validation,
- unresolved uncertainty,
- and inability to execute a required validation activity.

These conditions may have different methodological meanings and should not automatically be collapsed into criterion failure.

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## Criteria Alignment

The Validation Criteria Framework must remain aligned with:

**Validation Object → Validation Purpose → Validation Scope → Validation Depth → Validation Applicability → Validation Criteria**

A criterion unrelated to the approved Validation Mandate should not influence the validation determination without explicit governance justification.

Likewise, a material dimension required by the Validation Mandate should not remain without adequate criteria merely because suitable evaluation is difficult.

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## Criteria Completeness

VCRS evaluates whether the Validation Criteria Framework sufficiently represents the conditions necessary to answer the approved Validation Purpose.

Criteria completeness does not require every conceivable characteristic of the Validation Object to receive a criterion.

It requires the criteria set to cover the material conditions necessary for the governed validation.

Where material criterion gaps remain, validation should not proceed under the assumption that the Validation Mandate can be completely satisfied.

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## Criteria Conflict Governance

Validation criteria may conflict.

For example:

- one criterion may optimize performance while another limits risk,
- different regulatory requirements may establish incompatible thresholds,
- operational objectives may conflict with safety conditions,
- domain standards may use different definitions,
- or multiple evidence references may support different evaluation boundaries.

VCRS requires material criteria conflicts to be identified and governed before they are allowed to influence validation conclusions.

Criteria conflict must not be silently resolved through arbitrary selection.

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## Criteria Hierarchy

Where criteria have different authority, significance, or dependency relationships, a governed hierarchy may be established.

A hierarchy may identify:

- overriding criteria,
- mandatory baseline criteria,
- conditional criteria,
- subordinate criteria,
- composite criteria,
- or supporting criteria.

Criteria hierarchy must be justified and documented.

The hierarchy must not be altered merely because a different ordering would produce a preferred validation outcome.

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## Criteria Stability

Validation requires sufficiently stable evaluation conditions.

Criteria should therefore remain controlled during the validation process.

Stability does not mean criteria can never change.

It means that material criteria changes must be recognized as governance events.

Where criteria change after validation activity has begun, the impact upon:

- methodology,
- evidence requirements,
- execution,
- previous results,
- determination,
- and reliance

must be assessed.

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## Criteria Change Governance

Material criteria change may arise from:

- changed Validation Purpose,
- changed Validation Scope,
- new regulatory requirements,
- new scientific knowledge,
- changed operating conditions,
- newly identified risks,
- changed object characteristics,
- revised external standards,
- or discovery that an existing criterion is methodologically inadequate.

VCRS requires material changes to be:

- identified,
- justified,
- versioned,
- documented,
- propagated to affected validation activities,
- and traceable to the resulting validation record.

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## Criteria Versioning

A Validation Determination must remain associated with the criteria under which it was produced.

Where the Validation Criteria Framework materially changes, previous determinations should not automatically be interpreted as having been produced under the revised criteria.

Criteria versioning therefore provides the historical reference necessary to determine:

**Which criteria governed this validation determination?**

## Validation Criteria and Method Separation

VCRS establishes another important VALIDOS® distinction:

### Criteria define what must be demonstrated.

### Method defines how it will be examined.

A criterion such as a required accuracy threshold does not itself determine which statistical test, experimental design, dataset, benchmark, simulation, expert assessment, or other method must be used to evaluate it.

Keeping these responsibilities separate prevents validation criteria from becoming unnecessarily tied to one implementation technique.

## Validation Criteria and Evidence Separation

VCRS also distinguishes criteria from evidence.

**Criterion:** the condition against which validity is evaluated.

**Evidence:** the information used to determine whether that condition has been satisfied.

Strong evidence cannot compensate for a criterion that was never properly defined.

Likewise, well-defined criteria cannot produce a reliable determination without sufficient evidence.

These responsibilities therefore remain governed separately within VALIDOS®.

## Governance Boundary

Validation Criteria Standard begins when:

- a Validation Object has been sufficiently established,
- a Validation Purpose has been identified,
- Validation Scope has been defined,
- required Validation Depth has been calibrated,
- and sufficient applicability and limitation conditions exist to establish evaluation requirements.

It ends when a sufficiently complete, justified, stable, and traceable Validation Criteria Framework exists to support selection of validation methodology.

VCRS does not determine:

- Validation Object identity or boundary,
- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Scope,
- Validation Depth,
- technical validation methodology,
- evidence fitness,
- source reliability,
- validation execution,
- final Validation Determination,
- Validation State,
- reliance authorization,
- or revalidation requirements.

These responsibilities belong to other VALIDOS® Parent Standards.

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## Minimum Governance Requirements

A conforming implementation of VCRS should establish:

- 1. identifiable validation requirements,
- 2. explicit validation criteria,
- 3. traceable relationships between criteria and the Validation Mandate,
- 4. defined thresholds where required,
- 5. identifiable acceptance conditions,
- 6. identifiable rejection conditions,
- 7. classification of materially different criterion types where necessary,
- 8. governance of material criterion dependencies and conflicts,
- 9. criteria versioning and change control,

10. and a persistent Validation Criteria Framework capable of supporting subsequent validation methodology and

- execution.

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## Governance Outputs

VCRS may produce:

- Validation Criteria Framework,
- Validation Requirement Record,
- Validation Criterion Record,
- Criteria Applicability Map,
- Criteria Classification Record,
- Validation Threshold Record,
- Acceptance Condition Record,
- Rejection Condition Record,
- Criteria Dependency Map,
- Criteria Conflict Record,

- Criteria Completeness Determination,
- Criteria Version Record,
- Criteria Change Record.

These outputs provide the evaluation reference required by subsequent VALIDOS® governance.

## Operational Applications

Validation Criteria Standard may be applied across:

- artificial intelligence,
- autonomous systems,
- machine learning models,
- data and analytics,
- predictions and simulations,
- enterprise systems,
- financial services,
- healthcare,
- industrial operations,
- regulatory compliance,
- critical infrastructure,
- digital assets,
- digital identities,
- operational governance,
- public-sector systems,
- scientific and analytical environments,
- multi-system environments,
- and any governed environment requiring explicit validation criteria.

## Relationship to Other OOF Architectures

Validation Criteria Standard interoperates with:

- **GOA™**
- **OBIDENITY®**
- **INTEGROS®**
- **ORA™**
- **AGA™**
- **AIG®**
- **CLIA®**
- **MGIA™**
- **ASGA™**
- **RIS™**

by providing the canonical validation-governance methodology through which relevant governance, integrity, operational, accountability, identity, risk, cognitive, memory, autonomous-system, and other requirements may be translated into explicit validation criteria where appropriate.

VCRS does not replace the substantive governance responsibilities of these architectures.

It determines how relevant requirements become governed **validation conditions** against which a Validation Object can subsequently be evaluated.

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## Foundational Principle

**Validity cannot be governed against criteria that were never explicitly established.**

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## Canonical Closing Statement

**Validation Criteria Standard establishes the canonical evaluation-reference layer of VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture. By governing requirement identification, criterion definition, thresholds, acceptance and rejection conditions, classification, completeness, conflicts, hierarchy, stability, versioning, and change, VCRS ensures that validity is evaluated against explicit and traceable conditions established before validation conclusions are reached, creating the methodological foundation required for consistent, explainable, and governable validation.**

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## Validation Criteria Standard

**Architecture:** VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture
**Category:** AI & Interpretation · **Subcategory:** Validation Governance

**Canonical Definition: Validation Criteria Standard (VCRS)** defines the governance conditions under which the criteria, requirements, thresholds, acceptance conditions, rejection conditions, evaluation references, and decision boundaries used to determine validity are formally established, justified, structured, maintained, and controlled before validation methodology and execution are applied.

**Governed Space:** Validation Criteria

**Validity cannot be governed against criteria that were never explicitly established.**

→ View Standard

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# Module Architecture

→ Validation Requirement Derivation Module (VRDM)

→ Validation Criterion Formulation Module (VCFM)

→ Validation Threshold Calibration Module (VTCM)

→ Validation Acceptance & Rejection Conditions Module (VARCM)

→ Validation Criteria Coherence Module (VCCM)

# Parent Resources

→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map

→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index

→ VALIDOS® — Four-Layer Validation Protocol™

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# Standards Compatibility

→ Validation Purpose & Scope Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ Validation Method Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ Validation Execution Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ Validation Determination Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

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# Related Documents

→ About Validation Criteria Standard

→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer

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